

Article VI. Religious Council

Section I. Name

This organization shall be called the Religious Council of Furman University.

Section II. Purpose

The council shall meet to discuss and assist in program coordination of the member organizations and any phase of religious life on the campus which is in the interest of the student body, and to appropriate religious funds of the student body to its member organizations. It shall take a special interest in promoting an open, inviting, and respectful atmosphere within the religious community, and is responsible for enforcing Religious Council guidelines.

Section III. Membership

- A. In order to become a member of the Religious Council, the interested group must:
 - a. Be chartered by the Office of the Chaplains.
 - b. Present a constitution for their organization to the Religious Council.
 - c. Have a representative attend one Religious Council meeting, after which Religious Council may approve their constitution upon a majority vote.
 - d. An organization is considered a new organization for two academic terms.
- B. In order to remain a voting member in good standing, the following must be maintained:
 - a. The organization shall have an updated constitution on file with the Religious Council.
 - b. Each organization shall have a representative at all Religious Council meetings. Any organization whose representative is absent for more than two meetings a term or which is found in violation of the responsibilities set forth by Section VIII will no longer be considered a member in good standing. The Executive Committee may freeze funding for such organization after consultation with the chaplains and the leaders of the offending organization. The Religious Council must be notified immediately of any action to freeze funding, but no motion to reinstate funding will be entertained until the offending organization sends a representative for two consecutive meetings. Organizations may send substitute representatives in case of the necessary absence of their normal representative.
 - c. In the event that a representative is replaced during a term, the organization of that representative must contact the Executive Committee before the next meeting of Religious Council.
 - d. In the event that no representative for an organization is present for an entire term, that organization may have its constitution revoked by a majority vote of the full council. If a representative is not present for an entire academic year, that organization's constitution will be automatically revoked.
 - e. If an organization's constitution is revoked for nonattendance, the organization may be reinstated by a majority vote of the Council after the organization has attended one meeting (cf. Section III.A.c.). The organization will then be considered a new organization according to precedent.
- C. Voting membership shall consist of:
 - a. One representative from all chartered religious organizations.
- D. Non-voting membership shall consist of:

- a. The university chaplains, the campus ministers, and the faculty advisors of the member organizations.
- b. The President of the Religious Council, who may vote only in the case of a tie.
- c. The other executive officers of Religious Council if they chose not to serve as the voting representative of their organization.
- d. Any interested individuals welcomed by the Council.

Section IV. Meetings

- A. Religious Council shall hold meetings twice monthly unless otherwise decided by the council.
- B. The President may call special meetings but must notify the Council at least one week in advance.
- C. A quorum shall consist of two-thirds of the voting membership.
- D. Meetings shall be conducted under Robert's Rules at the discretion of the president.

Section V. Elections and officers

- A. Voting procedures for the election of officers:
 - a. Elections shall be held by the first meeting in March.
 - b. All nominees must have served for at least one academic term on the council. Nominees for president must have previously served for at least three academic terms. Outgoing representatives may be nominated, and if elected they may serve the following years as officers without officially representing any organization.
 - c. The order of election shall be as follows: president, vice-president, secretary, and treasurer.
 - d. The floor will be open for nominees for each office as prescribed above.
 - e. The vote shall be made by secret ballot with a majority needed to win.
 - f. The new representatives and officers shall take over at the last meeting of Spring term.
 - g. These dates may be changed if the council deems necessary.
 - h. In case of vacancies on the Executive Committee, new officers may be elected by the full Religious Council at the discretion of the Committee.
- B. Executive Committee
 - a. The Executive Committee shall be composed of the President, Vice President, Secretary, and Treasurer.
 - b. All members of the Executive Committee shall report to the President of the Religious Council and be accountable to the Religious Council. All outgoing and incoming members of the Executive Committee will serve as the Funding Committee and shall assist in the preparation of the Religious Council budget at the end of each year.
- C. The President of Religious Council shall:
 - a. Faithfully execute all provisions of the Constitution and the laws of the Religious Council.
 - b. Establish meeting times and preside over all meetings of the council.
 - c. Appoint committee chairpersons as needed, subject to the majority approval of the Religious Council.
 - d. Vote as a member of Religious Council only in the case of a tie.
 - e. Oversee all constitutionally prescribed elections.

- f. Have knowledge of all committees of the Religious Council.
 - g. Appoint such officials and committees as shall be needed to assist him/her in the performance of his/her duties as deemed necessary by a majority vote of the Religious Council.
 - h. Represent Religious Council as the Secretary of Religious Affairs in all interactions with the Student Government Association (SGA). This duty may be delegated to another member of the Religious Council, provided the delegate is approved by a majority of council. The President will attend SGA meetings on the same basis as other SGA members and report to Religious Council anything that is going on in SGA that concerns religious life on campus.
 - i. Call and chair meetings of the executive committee when necessary.
- D. The Vice-President of Religious Council shall:
- a. Act in full capacity of the duties of the president in case of his/her absence and succeed him/her in case of vacancy.
 - b. Be responsible for maintaining the electronic and print databases of organizational constitutions and providing members of Religious Council with up-to-date copies of all information and guidelines related to council operations.
 - c. Sign all budgeted check requests in absence of the treasurer of Religious Council.
- E. The Secretary of Religious Council shall:
- a. Record, preserve, and present for the inspection to any member of Religious Council, upon request and sufficient notice, all papers, proceedings, rolls of attendance, and other records of the council.
 - b. Circulate to administration, professors, chaplains, all Religious Council members, "The Paladin," WFTV News, and WPLS-FM information concerning campus-wide religious activities.
 - c. Coordinate all publicity for Religious Council, which includes bulletin boards, posters, and all other publicity which the Religious Council deems necessary.
 - d. Chair all publicity committees for Religious Council.
- F. The Treasurer of Religious Council shall:
- a. Record all bank statements and be responsible for keeping a record of all funds and expenditures of the Religious Council.
 - b. Submit to the council an oral report of the state of the treasury at every meeting.
 - c. Prepare written financial reports for SGA and/or the Religious Council upon request.
 - d. Maintain communication with representatives regarding the finances of their respective organizations.
 - e. Approve all budgeted check requests.

Section VI. Financing

- A. Religious Council shall be responsible for administering funds to the chartered religious Organizations.
- a. Budget requests shall be considered following the election of new officers in March.
 - b. Student services will make available a predetermined percentage of the estimated student activities fee to Religious Council to budget to the members of Religious Council.
 - c. Religious Council spending guidelines may adapt to suit the particular needs of religious groups with the unanimous consent of Religious Council.

- d. Member groups submitting budget requests should provide justification for funding for each expense in order to assist the Executive Committee in preparing budgets for the next year.
- e. Religious Council shall exercise general supervision over all expenditures of the funds granted to member organizations.
- f. If funds not originally budgeted are requested by a group for the purpose of a specific event, and if such funds exceed standard honorarium pay, Religious Council must be acknowledged as a co-sponsor in all publicity materials for said event. Funds which may be counted towards exceeding honorarium pay shall include but not be limited to speaker's fees, traveling expenses, publicity, room and board, venue fees, or other disbursements not foreseen by this document.
- g. A new organization will receive \$250 a term (cf. Section III.A.d.)

Section VII. Powers

- A. Religious Council shall exercise general supervision over all religious activities of the member groups.
- B. Religious Council shall represent the various member groups in all matters generally affecting them.
- C. Religious Council shall require regular reports of the activities of the member organizations.

Section VIII. Member Responsibilities

- A. Each member of Religious Council shall:
 - a. Provide each spring a description of their religious organization officers list (including their Religious Council representative), meeting times, and the meeting place of their group for the next fall term by the deadline determined by the Executive Committee.
 - b. Submit budget requests no later than two weeks after Executive Committee elections.
 - c. Furnish the Vice President with an updated copy of their constitution by the third meeting of the fall term.
 - d. Strive to have a representative present at every meeting of the Religious Council.
 - e. Abide by the guidelines set forth by Religious Council.

Section IX. Constitutional Amendment

- A. This constitution may be amended by a majority vote of the Religious Council
- B. Any proposed amendment must be presented to the council in writing one meeting prior to the vote on the amendment.